

Preparation - Before Level 1

Document: Preparation - Before Level 1
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Chain: n/a
Tx: [not anchored]
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Allow 45-90 minutes plus download time. Finish before the 90-minute lesson or attend the setup clinic. You need your own Windows or Mac computer, power, permission to install software, and internet for setup. A phone can read the lesson but cannot run this starter.

Choose one route at each layer

Layer	Choices	Why
Coding helper	Claude Code or Codex; manual card if access is blocked	Helps you understand and edit the project
App answer engine	Ollama, Claude API, or OpenAI API	Answers document questions while the app runs

A coding-assistant subscription does not automatically supply API credits for this app. You only need the accounts for your selected route. Local Ollama has no per-answer API fee; hardware and electricity still have costs.

Follow this order

Step / where	Action	Why	Expected result	Recovery
1 / computer settings	Follow your Windows or Mac hardware check	Finds incompatible or locked devices early	OS, RAM, disk, and permissions recorded	Use cloud generation if local model cannot run; ask for the setup clinic if installation is blocked
2 / browser	Open GitHub signup ; create or sign into your account; verify the email	A verified account can create a fork	GitHub shows your username	Complete verification or use account recovery before class
3 / GitHub Desktop	Download , install, launch, and choose Sign in to GitHub.com; authorize in the browser	Connects the local project to your account	Desktop shows the same username as the browser	Sign out of the wrong account and sign back in
4 / browser	Open the course repo ; Fork; select your personal owner; keep the name; Create fork	Your changes belong to you	Owner is your username and the parent is celaya-solutions	If it says repository not found, the course release is not public yet; contact instructor
5 / Desktop	File > Clone Repository; GitHub.com; select YOUR fork; choose a local folder; Clone. Choose For my own purposes if prompted	Downloads files and keeps pushes aimed at your fork	Local README, pyproject.toml, uv.lock, and projects folder exist	Refresh the repo list or use the URL tab with your fork URL
6 / terminal	Follow your OS guide to install uv, reopen the terminal, and open the clone's root	Commands need the course folder	uv --version works; directory listing contains pyproject.toml	Follow the matching PATH or folder recovery step
7 / terminal	Run <code>uv sync --frozen</code>	Creates the locked Python environment	Dependencies install; no lockfile changes	Recheck network and free disk; copy the error category for the instructor
8 / chosen assistant	Complete coding-assistant setup and open this clone	Makes a guided edit possible	Assistant explains README without edits	Use the manual edit card if account access is blocked
9 / terminal	Complete model setup , then <code>uv run --frozen zta setup</code>	Selects the app's one answer engine	Provider and model are shown, key is never printed	Rerun setup to correct the selection
10 / terminal	<code>uv run --frozen zta doctor documents</code>	Checks parsing and provider reachability	PASS lines; any NOTE is read	Match the issue in Recovery
11 / terminal and browser	<code>uv run --frozen zta start documents</code> ; open http://127.0.0.1:8501 ; load binder, build index, fill predictions, run question 1	Confirms real generation and billing, beyond connectivity	Answer cites El Paso source; no service error	Use provider recovery; never infer billing access from model-list access alone
12 / course platform	Follow submission setup ; find Level 1 upload control	Avoids last-minute enrollment problems	Assignment opens as a student	Resolve sign-in, enrollment, or closed assignment before class
13 / browser	From Releases , download learner-materials ZIP; extract it using Finder or Explorer; open lesson and saved-example PDFs	Keeps teaching material available offline	Both PDFs open with network off	Use included Markdown/text if a PDF reader fails

Preparation receipt

Write your OS, RAM, free disk, coding assistant, provider, model, doctor result, practice-answer result, and assignment access in the setup clinic sheet. Do not write a key. Preparation is complete only after an actual answer and access to the upload control.

The 16 GB RAM / 10 GB free-storage target is a planning target, not a tested guarantee for every device. Use the release verification report to see the actual pilot hardware. Hardware and download delays do not lower your learning grade.